



Choosing the Right Cloud Security Tools

There are many cloud security tools on offer today, and each has its benefits as well as limitations. Let's understand the tricky world of these tools and see how we can choose the right one for strong defences.

Most of my work involves discussing cloud security with clients, and one of the most common questions I get is: “How do we implement security best practices in the cloud?” That’s when the conversation often circles back to this never-ending debate — ‘Cloud-native CSP tools vs third-party commercial tools vs open source tools: Choosing the ultimate winner’.

With enterprises shifting towards agile and multi-cloud setups, security is increasingly being viewed as a challenge. Cloud security tools are crucial for keeping complex cloud systems safe because the latter are hard to manage manually. These tools are

typically classified into the following three categories.

- **Cloud-native tools** are offered by cloud service providers (CSPs) such as AWS, Google Cloud Platform, and Microsoft Azure. These are usually in the form of services integrated within the cloud platform such as Security Hub and GuardDuty from AWS, Security Command Center of GCP, etc.
- **Third-party commercial tools** are developed by various specialised vendors. Examples include security solutions from companies like Crowdstrike, Checkpoint, and Fortigate.

- **Open source tools** are created and maintained by the community and are free of cost. Examples include cloud security tools like Prowler and Scoutsuite.

Let’s see how these three categories of tools vary and when one might use them.

Cloud-native tools

These tools are provided directly by CSPs like AWS, Google Cloud, and Microsoft Azure, in the form of services. They offer some distinct advantages like seamlessly integrating with other services from the same CSP, making implementation a piece of cake. Plus, they’re often equipped